

# Prudence

Exhibited in the manifestation of God's grace.

Ephesians 1:8 Wherein he hath abounded toward us in all wisdom and prudence;

Exemplified by Christ.

Isaiah 52:13 Behold, my Servant shall deal prudently, he shall be exalted and extolled, and be very high.

Matthew 21:24-27 And Jesus answered and said unto them, I also will ask you one thing, which if ye tell me, I in like wise will tell you by what Authority I do these things.

25 The baptism of John, whence was it? from heaven, or of men? And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say unto us, Why did ye not then believe him? 26 But if we shall say, Of men; we fear the people; for all hold John as a prophet. 27 And they answered Jesus, and said, We cannot tell. And he said unto them, Neither tell I you by what Authority I do these things.

Matthew 22:15-21 Then went the Pharisees, and took counsel how they might entangle him in his talk. 16 And they sent out unto him their disciples with the Herodians, saying, Master, we know that thou Art true, and teachest the way of God in truth, neither carest thou for any man: for thou regardest not the person of men. 17 Tell us therefore, What thinkest thou? Is it lawful to give tribute unto Caesar, or not? 18 But Jesus perceived their wickedness, and said, Why tempt ye me, ye hypocrites? ...

Intimately connected with wisdom.

Proverbs 8:12 I wisdom dwell with prudence, and find out knowledge of witty inventions. The wise celebrated for.

Proverbs 16:21 The wise in heart shall be called prudent: and the sweetness of the lips increaseth learning.

THEY WHO HAVE,

Get knowledge.

Proverbs 18:15 The heart of the prudent getteth knowledge; and the ear of the wise seeketh knowledge.

Deal with knowledge.

Proverbs 13:16 Every prudent man dealeth with knowledge: but a fool layeth open his folly.

Look well to their goings.

Proverbs 14:15 The simple believeth every word: but the prudent man looketh well to his going.

Understand the ways of God.

Hosea 14:9 Who is wise, and he shall understand these things? prudent, and he shall know them? for the ways of the LORD are right, and the just shall walk in them: but the transgressors shall fall therein.

Understand their own ways.

Proverbs 14:8 The wisdom of the prudent is to understand his way: but the folly of fools is deceit.

Crowned with knowledge.

Proverbs 14:18 The simple inherit folly: but the prudent are crowned with knowledge.

Not ostentatious of knowledge.

Proverbs 12:23 A prudent man concealeth knowledge: but the heart of fools proclaimeth foolishness.

Foresee and avoid evil.

Proverbs 22:3 A prudent man foreseeeth the evil, and hideth himself: but the simple pass on, and are Punished.

Are preserved by it.

Proverbs 2:11 Discretion shall preserve thee, understanding shall keep thee:

Suppress angry feelings, ect.

Proverbs 12:16 A fool's wrath is presently known: but a prudent man covereth shame.

Proverbs 19:11 The discretion of a man deferreth his Anger; and it is his glory to pass over a transgression.

Regard reproof.

Proverbs 15:5 A fool despiseth his Father's instruction: but he that regardeth reproof is prudent.

Keep silence in the evil time.

Amos 5:13 Therefore the prudent shall keep silence in that time; for it is an evil time.

Saints act with.

Psalm 112:5 A good man sheweth favour, and lendeth: he will guide his affairs with discretion.

Saints should especially exercise, in their intercourse with unbelievers.

Matthew 10:16 Behold, I send you forth as sheep in the midst of wolves: be ye therefore wise as serpents, and harmless as doves.

Ephesians 5:15 See then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise,

Colossians 4:5 Walk in wisdom toward them that are without, redeeming the time.

Virtuous wives act with.

Proverbs 31:16 She considereth a field, and buyeth it: with the fruit of her hands she planteth a vineyard.

Proverbs 31:26 She openeth her mouth with wisdom; and in her tongue is The Law of kindness.

The young should cultivate.

Proverbs 3:21 My son, let not them depart from thine eyes: keep sound wisdom and discretion:

OF THE WICKED

Fails in times of perplexity.

Jeremiah 49:7 Concerning Edom, thus saith the LORD of hosts; Is wisdom no more in Teman? is counsel perished from the prudent? is their wisdom vanished?

Keeps them from the knowledge of the Gospel.

Matthew 11:25 At that time Jesus answered and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes.

Denounced by God.

Isaiah 5:21 Woe unto them that are wise in their own eyes, and prudent in their own sight!

Isaiah 29:15 Woe unto them that seek deep to hide their counsel from the LORD, and their works are in the dark, and they say, Who seeth us? and who knoweth us?

Defeated by God.

Isaiah 29:14 Therefore, behold, I will proceed to do a marvellous work among this people, even a marvellous work and a wonder: for the wisdom of their wise men shall perish, and the understanding of their prudent men shall be hid.

1 Corinthians 1:19 For it is written, I will destroy the wisdom of the wise, and will bring to nothing the understanding of the prudent.

Necessity for Illustrated.

Matthew 25:3 They that were foolish took their lamps, and took no oil with them:

Matthew 25:9 But the wise answered, saying, Not so; lest there be not enough for us and you: but go ye rather to them that sell, and buy for yourselves.

Exemplified.

Jacob,

Genesis 32:3-23 And Jacob sent messengers before him to Esau his brother unto the land of Seir, the country of Edom. 4 And he commanded them, saying, Thus shall ye speak unto my lord Esau; Thy Servant Jacob saith thus, I have sojourned with Laban, and stayed there until now: 5 And I have oxen, and asses, flocks, and menservants, and womenservants: and I have sent to tell my lord, that I may find grace in thy sight. 6 And the messengers returned to Jacob, saying, We came to thy brother Esau, and also he cometh to meet thee, and four hundred men with him. ...

Joseph,

Genesis 41:39 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, Forasmuch as God hath shewed thee all this, there is none so discreet and wise as thou Art:

Jethro,

Exodus 18:19-23 Hearken now unto my voice, I will give thee counsel, and God shall be with thee: Be thou for the people to God-ward, that thou mayest bring the causes unto God: 20 And thou shalt Teach them ordinances and laws, and shalt shew them the way wherein they must walk, and the work that they must do. 21 Moreover thou shalt provide out of all the people able men, such as fear God, men of truth, hating covetousness; and place such over them, to be rulers of thousands, and rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens: 22 And let them Judge the people at all seasons: and it shall be, that every great matter they shall bring unto thee, but every small matter they shall Judge: so shall it be easier for thyself, and they shall bear the burden with thee. ...

Gideon,

Judges 8:1-3 And the men of Ephraim said unto him, Why hast thou served us thus, that thou calledst us not, when thou wentest to fight with the Midianites? And they did Chide with him sharply. 2 And he said unto them, What have I done now in comparison of you? Is not the gleaning of the grapes of Ephraim better than the vintage of Abiezer? 3 God hath delivered into your hands the Princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb: and what was I able to do in comparison of you? Then their Anger was Abated toward him, when he had said that.

David,

1 Samuel 16:18 Then answered one of the servants, and said, Behold, I have seen a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite, that is cunning in playing, and a mighty valiant man, and a man of war, and prudent in matters, and a Comely person, and the LORD is with him.

Abigail,

1 Samuel 25:23-31 And when Abigail saw David, she hasted, and lighted off the ass, and fell before David on her face, and bowed herself to the ground, 24 And fell at his feet, and said, Upon me, my lord, upon me let this iniquity be: and let thine handmaid, I pray thee, speak in thine audience, and hear the words of thine handmaid. 25 Let not my lord, I pray thee, regard this man of Belial, even Nabal: for as his name is, so is he; Nabal is his name, and folly is with him: but I thine handmaid saw not the young men of my lord, whom thou didst send. 26 Now therefore, my lord, as the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, seeing the LORD hath withholden thee from coming to shed blood, and from avenging thyself with thine own hand, now let thine enemies, and they that seek evil to my lord, be as Nabal. ...

2 Samuel 15:32-34 And it came to pass, that when David was come to the top of the mount, where he worshipped God, behold, Hushai the Archite came to meet him with his coat rent, and earth upon his head: 33 Unto whom David said, If thou passest on with me, then thou shalt be a burden unto me: 34 But if thou return to the city, and say unto Absalom, I will be thy Servant, O king; as I have been thy Father's Servant hitherto, so will I now also be thy Servant: then mayest thou for me defeat the counsel of Ahithophel.

2 Samuel 17:6-14 And when Hushai was come to Absalom, Absalom spake unto him, saying, Ahithophel hath spoken after this manner: shall we do after his saying? if not; speak thou. 7 And Hushai said unto Absalom, The counsel that Ahithophel hath given is not good at this time. 8 For, said Hushai, thou knowest thy Father and his men, that they be mighty men, and they be chafed in their minds, as a bear robbed of her whelps

in the field: and thy Father is a man of war, and will not lodge with the people. 9 Behold, he is hid now in some pit, or in some other place: and it will come to pass, when some of them be overthrown at the first, that whosoever heareth it will say, There is a slaughter among the people that follow Absalom. ...

Aged Counsellors of Rehoboam,

1 Kings 12:7 And they spake unto him, saying, If thou wilt be a Servant unto this people this day, and wilt serve them, and answer them, and speak good words to them, then they will be thy servants for ever.

Solomon,

2 Chronicles 2:12 Hiram said moreover, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, that made heaven and earth, who hath given to David the king a wise son, endued with prudence and understanding, that might build an house for the LORD, and an house for his kingdom.

Nehemiah,

Nehemiah 2:12-16 And I arose in the night, I and some few men with me; neither told I any man what my God had put in my heart to do at Jerusalem: neither was there any beast with me, save the beast that I rode upon. 13 And I went out by night by the gate of the valley, even before the Dragon well, and to the dung port, and viewed the walls of Jerusalem, which were broken down, and the gates thereof were consumed with fire. 14 Then I went on to the gate of the fountain, and to the king's pool: but there was no place for the beast that was under me to pass. 15 Then went I up in the night by the brook, and viewed the wall, and turned back, and entered by the gate of the valley, and so returned. ...

Nehemiah 4:13-18 Therefore set I in the lower places behind the wall, and on the higher places, I even set the people after their families with their swords, their spears, and their bows. 14 And I looked, and rose up, and said unto the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, Be not ye afraid of them: remember the Lord, which is great and terrible, and fight for your Brethren, your sons, and your daughters, your wives, and your houses. 15 And it came to pass, when our enemies heard that it was known unto us, and God had brought their counsel to nought, that we returned all of us to the wall, every one unto his work. 16 And it came to pass from that time forth, that the half of my servants wrought in the work, and the other half of them held both the spears, the shields, and the bows, and the habergeons; and the rulers were behind all the house of Judah. ...

The Poor Wise Man,

Ecclesiastes 9:15 Now there was found in it a poor wise man, and he by his wisdom delivered the city; yet no man remembered that same poor man.

The Scribe,

Mark 12:32-34 And the scribe said unto him, Well, Master, thou hast said the truth: for there is one God; and there is none other but he: 33 And to love him with all the heart, and with all the understanding, and with all the soul, and with all the strength, and to love his neighbour as himself, is more than all whole Burnt Offerings and sacrifices. 34 And when Jesus saw that he answered discreetly, he said unto him, Thou Art not far from the Kingdom of God. And no man after that Durst ask him any question.

Gamaliel,

Acts 5:34-39 Then stood there up one in the council, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a doctor of The Law, had in reputation among all the people, and commanded to put the Apostles forth a little space; 35 And said unto them, Ye men of Israel, take heed to yourselves what ye intend to do as touching these men. 36 For before these days rose

up Theudas, boasting himself to be somebody; to whom a number of men, about four hundred, joined themselves: who was slain; and all, as many as obeyed him, were scattered, and brought to nought. 37 After this man rose up Judas of Galilee in the days of the taxing, and drew away much people after him: he also perished; and all, even as many as obeyed him, were dispersed. ...

Sergius Paulus,

Acts 13:7 Which was with the deputy of the country, Sergius Paulus, a prudent man; who called for Barnabas and Saul, and desired to hear the word of God.

Paul,

Acts 23:6 But when Paul perceived that the one part were Sadducees, and the other Pharisees, he cried out in the council, Men and Brethren, I am a Pharisee, the son of a Pharisee: of the hope and resurrection of the Dead I am called in question.